

COVER PAGE

Fitter Snacker Business Process Analysis Project

INFO 3240 – Enterprise Resource Planning Systems

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Introduction

As identified in the previously submitted project charter, Fitter Snacker is currently using QuickBooks for accounting along with separate systems for sales, inventory management, and human resources. While these systems were sufficient when the company was smaller, continued business growth has created operational inefficiencies due to disconnected systems and the lack of centralized data management.

This fragmented system structure has resulted in data duplication, manual data entry, and inconsistent information across departments. Because the systems are not integrated, employees often need to enter the same information multiple times, increasing the likelihood of errors and delays.

Operational analysis revealed several measurable problems within the organization. Approximately 17% of customer orders contain errors due to manual data entry and lack of system integration. Around 20% of deliveries are late because inventory and production information are not updated in real time. Inventory levels are estimated to be about 20% higher than necessary due to inaccurate demand forecasting, while high-demand product stockouts occur in approximately 10–12% of cases. Additionally, the monthly financial closing process currently takes about 10 days because accounting staff must manually reconcile data between systems.

These operational issues highlight the need for an integrated Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) system that can connect business processes into a centralized platform. ERP systems integrate accounting, sales, inventory management, supply chain operations, and human resources into a single system supported by a shared database. This integration improves data visibility, reduces operational errors, and supports better decision-making across the organization.

To address these challenges, Fitter Snacker is evaluating several open-source ERP solutions that can meet the company's operational requirements while remaining cost-effective and scalable for future growth.

Candidate ERP Solutions

To determine the most suitable ERP system for Fitter Snacker, two open-source ERP platforms were evaluated: **Odoo** and **ERPNext**. Both systems provide integrated business management capabilities and are widely used by small and medium-sized businesses.

Odoo

Odoo is a modular open-source ERP system that provides a wide range of business applications including customer relationship management (CRM), accounting, inventory management, manufacturing, human resources, and project management. Odoo is widely adopted by organizations around the world due to its modern interface and extensive ecosystem of modules.

The platform offers a free community edition as well as a paid enterprise edition that includes additional features and official support. Odoo's modular design allows businesses to start with essential applications and expand functionality as their needs grow. The system also supports integration with many third-party applications through APIs and extensions.

Because of its large developer community and global adoption, Odoo has a strong ecosystem of consultants, developers, and support resources. Regular updates and security patches ensure that the system continues to evolve and remain competitive in the ERP market.

However, while the community version of Odoo is free, many advanced features and enterprise-level support require paid subscriptions. This can increase long-term costs for organizations depending on the required functionality.

ERPNext

ERPNext is a fully open-source ERP system designed to provide comprehensive business management capabilities without requiring expensive licensing fees. ERPNext includes integrated modules for accounting, inventory management, manufacturing, customer relationship management, human resources, and supply chain management.

One of ERPNext's strengths is its strong support for manufacturing and inventory management processes, which makes it particularly suitable for companies like Fitter Snacker that produce physical products. The system allows businesses to manage production planning, bills of materials, stock levels, and order processing within a single platform.

ERPNext is web-based and can be deployed on a local server or cloud infrastructure. The platform also provides extensive documentation, an active open-source community, and regular updates to improve functionality and security.

Because ERPNext is fully open-source, businesses can customize the system according to their operational requirements without significant licensing costs. This flexibility makes ERPNext attractive for small and medium-sized companies seeking an affordable ERP solution.

ERP System Evaluation and Comparison

The two ERP systems were evaluated using several criteria including cost, usability, interoperability, platform support, documentation, support availability, configurability, and long-term viability.

Evaluation Criteria	Odoo	ERPNext
Cost	Free community edition but many advanced features require paid enterprise version	Fully open-source and free
Usability	Very modern interface with highly polished design	Simple and intuitive web-based interface
Interoperability	Supports integrations through APIs and third-party modules	Provides REST APIs and integration capabilities
Multi-platform Support	Can run on Linux, Windows, Mac, and cloud environments	Web-based system typically deployed on Linux servers
Documentation	Extensive official documentation and tutorials	Strong documentation and active community guides
Supportability	Large ecosystem of consultants and enterprise support	Community support and growing consultant ecosystem

Bug Fix Timeliness	Frequent updates and patches from Odoo developers	Active open-source updates and improvements
Configurability	Highly customizable through modules and extensions	Flexible configuration and workflow customization
External Consultants	Large global network of ERP consultants	Smaller but growing network of consultants
Popularity	One of the most widely adopted ERP systems globally	Popular among small and medium-sized businesses
Future Roadmap	Strong corporate development and enterprise backing	Active open-source development community

Both ERP systems offer strong capabilities and can support integrated business management. However, the cost structure, customization flexibility, and alignment with Fitter Snacker's operational requirements were key considerations in selecting the most appropriate solution.

Recommendation

Based on the evaluation criteria, ERPNext is recommended as the ERP solution for Fitter Snacker.

ERPNext provides comprehensive functionality for inventory management, manufacturing operations, accounting, and sales management while remaining fully open-source and cost-effective. These capabilities align closely with Fitter Snacker's operational requirements, particularly in managing production planning and inventory levels more efficiently.

Compared to Odoo, ERPNext offers greater flexibility without requiring additional licensing costs for advanced features. This is an important consideration for a mid-sized organization that wants to control implementation expenses while maintaining the ability to customize the system as business needs evolve.

ERPNext also supports centralized data management, which will help eliminate the data silos currently affecting Fitter Snacker's operations. By integrating sales, inventory, accounting, and supply chain processes into a single system, ERPNext can significantly reduce manual data entry, improve real-time reporting, and increase coordination between departments.

Furthermore, ERPNext's strong support for manufacturing workflows makes it particularly well suited for a production-focused company like Fitter Snacker. Features such as bills of materials, production planning, and inventory tracking will allow the company to better manage supply chain activities and reduce stockouts or excess inventory.

For these reasons, ERPNext represents the most suitable ERP platform to support Fitter Snacker's operational improvements and long-term growth.

Conclusion

Fitter Snacker's current system environment, which relies on QuickBooks and separate business applications, has created significant operational challenges including order errors, delayed deliveries, and inefficient inventory management. Implementing an ERP system is necessary to integrate business processes and provide centralized data visibility across the organization.

Both Odoo and ERPNext were evaluated as potential ERP solutions due to their open-source availability and comprehensive business management capabilities. While Odoo offers a highly polished interface and a large ecosystem of developers and consultants, ERPNext provides a fully open-source platform with strong manufacturing and inventory management functionality.

After evaluating both systems across multiple criteria, ERPNext was selected as the recommended solution because of its flexibility, cost-effectiveness, and alignment with Fitter Snacker's operational needs. Implementing ERPNext will allow the company to streamline processes, reduce operational errors, improve decision-making, and support future business growth.

In the next phase of the project, ERPNext will be implemented and tested to further evaluate its functionality within the Fitter Snacker business environment.

AI Disclosure Statement

Artificial intelligence tools were used in a limited capacity to assist with grammar checking, formatting, and improving clarity of language. All research, analysis, ideas, and final content were reviewed and approved by the authors. The work submitted represents our original effort in accordance with academic integrity guidelines.